

Larasati (Lara) Ayu Wulandari

Toronto, Canada • lara.wulandari@mail.utoronto.ca • 647-2481715 • lara-wulandari.github.io

Education

University of Toronto, Direct Entry PhD in Economics 2022 – 2028 (expected)

- Specialization: Development & Environmental Economics
- Awards: Department of Economics Graduate Program Award; Edward B. Kernaghan Fellowship; University of Toronto Fellowship; June Scott Teaching Excellence Award

University of Toronto, Honours Bachelor of Science 2018 – 2022

- Awards: Lester B. Pearson International Scholarship (full scholarship); Laidlaw Research & Leadership Program; University of Toronto Undergraduate Research Awards; Transition Titan Award

Working Papers

Plastic Waste Trade and Environmental Leakage (*Solo-authored*)

- Combines Chinese customs data with health, environmental, and firm-level datasets to examine how import restrictions on plastic waste reshape private market behavior across upstream and downstream sectors.
- Studies how regulatory shocks affect importing firms, market structure, and local environmental and health outcomes.

Relational Contracts and Agricultural Supply Chains in Kenya

with Russell Morton and Eleanor Wiseman

- Examines trade credit, enforcement mechanisms, and private contracting between retailers and traders in agricultural value chains.
- Uses original field data to analyze how informal financing arrangements influence market participation and investment incentives.

Research Experience

Research Assistant (and Co-author) May 2025 – Present

for Russell Morton (University of Rochester), Eleanor Wiseman (University of Wisconsin Madison)

- Clean and analyze pilot data on retailer–trader relationships, producing descriptive statistics and regression output to examine trends and selection into takeup.
- Derive and implement relational contract models in Python, translating theoretical results into computational simulations.
- Conduct one month of fieldwork in Kenya, interviewing retailers and traders in agricultural markets; co-design survey instruments and document findings for research outputs.

Research Assistant, University of Toronto Nov 2022 – Sept 2023

for Arthur Blouin (University of Toronto), Davide del Prete (University of Naples Parthenope), Rocco Macchiavello (London School of Economics)

- Managed and harmonized World Bank Living Standards Measurement Study data across 16 countries, writing reproducible Stata code.
- Integrated large-scale geocoded datasets of coffee farmers in developing countries, merging geospatial and ethnographic data for applied development research.
- Conducted econometric analysis, examining gender differences in crop cultivation.
- Developed detailed data dictionaries and documentation to support replication and team use.

Policy Researcher, Canada Global Health, Security & Diplomacy Sept 2021 – Aug 2022

- Conducted policy analysis of global COVID-19 responses, including World Bank and its multilateral development strategies.
- Synthesized quantitative and institutional evidence into concise policy briefs for decisionmakers.
- Supervised a team of interns, managing timelines and ensuring analytical consistency across outputs.

Research Assistant, Chinese University of Hong Kong July 2021 – Apr 2022

- Conducted regression analysis on large-scale family survey data to estimate time-use effects on family and educational outcomes.
- Produced publication-quality tables, figures, and empirical write-ups (data, methods, results).
- Co-authored a study on nonstandard maternal work schedules and child educational engagement using structural equation modeling.

Research Intern, Ontario Institute for Studies in Education May 2021 – Sept 2021

- Conducted a structured literature review on internationalization in higher education, synthesizing evidence on cross-national enrollment and tuition trends.
- Analyzed longitudinal administrative and survey data to examine institutional responses to globalization.
- Produced written summaries and data visualizations to support research presentations and reports.

Other Experience

Course Instructor, University of Toronto Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- Prepared slides and delivered weekly lectures on intermediate microeconomics for 30+ undergraduate students.
- Developed and graded all course assessments; supervised a teaching assistant in delivering tutorials.
- Received average teaching evaluations of 4.3+/5 and won the June Scott Teaching Excellence Award.

Teaching Assistant, University of Toronto Sept 2021 – Present

- Led weekly tutorials for intermediate microeconomic & econometrics courses with approximately 40 students per section .
- Graded exams and written assignments across multiple undergraduate economics courses.
- Provided academic support through regular office hours.

Technical Skills

- **Statistical Software:** Stata (advanced), R (advanced), Python (intermediate)
- **Other:** Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint, Word; academic and policy-oriented writing